failure, and the cost–benefit analysis that was used to discover the best intervention. After a few years, it is useful to engage in ex post review, and change course if the original objectives were not met. Cost–benefit analysis is not a science, and there is a significant imprecision in all such estimates.

We always see things more clearly in hindsight. The idea of ex post review is not to pillory the people who looked at the information at a certain point in time, e.g., in a moment of crisis, and made a decision. It is to establish feedback loops through which a process of iterative refinement sets in.

Cost–benefit analysis is required for government *intervention* into society. It is not essential when doing internal reorganization of government organizations.

The laws that give power to government agencies to intervene in society must codify the processes of cost–benefit analysis and ex post review. Through this, it induces an institutionalized application of mind, and improves the quality of work.